Hypoglycemia Quick Action

Low blood sugar (<70 mg/dL) can escalate quickly. Keep this chart where you check glucose — and teach household members the same steps.

Early warning signs

- Shakiness, sweating, clammy skin
- Fast heartbeat, anxiety
- Hunger, irritability
- Tingling lips or tongue
- Mild confusion or dizziness

Severe — get help now

- Inability to swallow safely
- Seizure or loss of consciousness
- Extreme confusion / combativeness
- Cannot treat themselves

Do not force food or drink. Use glucagon if prescribed and call emergency services.

The 15–15 Rule

1. **Check** — Confirm glucose is under 70 mg/dL (treat if symptomatic and you can't check).
2. **Treat** — Take **15 grams** of fast-acting carbohydrate.
3. **Wait 15 minutes** — Recheck. If still <70, repeat another 15g.
4. **Follow up** — Once stable, eat a snack with protein/carbs if your next meal is more than an hour away.

Fast-acting 15g carb options

LIQUIDS

- 4 oz (½ cup) juice
- 4 oz regular soda
- 1 tbsp honey or syrup

TABLETS / GELS

- 3–4 glucose tablets
- 1 tube glucose gel
- Follow package labeling

OTHER

- ~6–7 hard candies*
- 1 tbsp sugar
- *Not chocolate — fat slows absorption

If someone is unconscious or can't swallow

Call emergency services. Give glucagon per training (injection or nasal). Place person on their side after glucagon. Never put food, juice, or candy in an unconscious person's mouth.